



UNIT 3

HARDWARE



Learning Objectives

- Define hardware.
- Recognize and understand functions of key hardware components (e.g., keyboard, RAM, hard disk, motherboard).
- Differentiate between temporary (RAM) and permanent storage (hard disk).
- Understand the roles of the motherboard and computer casing.



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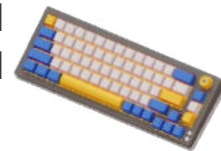
A computer is made up of various components, some of which we can see and touch, while others are not visible. The parts we can touch are known as **hardware**. These parts help the computer to work and do different tasks. Let's explore some important parts of a computer and their functions.



COMMON HARDWARE PARTS

• KEYBOARD

The keyboard is the most commonly used device. It helps us enter letters, numbers, and instructions into the computer.



• SCANNER

A scanner lets us take a printed picture or document and turn it into a digital file on the computer.



• MICROPHONE

A microphone captures sound and sends it to the computer. It is also called a Mic.



• JOYSTICK

A joystick is used mostly for playing games. It has a handle that can move in all directions to control the game.





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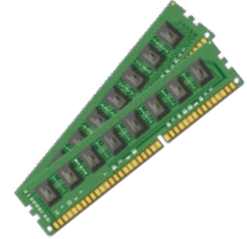
• DIGITAL CAMERA

A digital camera is used to take pictures that can be saved and viewed on a computer.



• RAM (RANDOM ACCESS MEMORY)

RAM is the part of the computer that stores data temporarily. It is called "temporary memory" because it only keeps information when the computer is on.



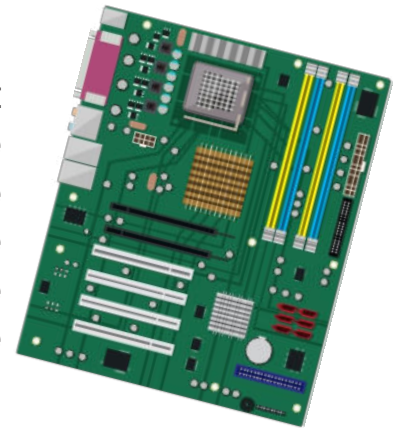
• HARD DISK

The hard disk is the computer's permanent storage. It stores all the files and information, even when the computer is turned off.



• MOTHERBOARD

The motherboard is the main circuit board inside the computer. All the important parts of the computer, like the keyboard, mouse, and hard disk, are connected to the motherboard. If the motherboard stops working, the computer will not be able to function properly.



• CONNECTORS AND PORTS

Each part of the computer connects to the motherboard using special points called ports. The cables or ends of devices we use to connect to the ports are called connectors.



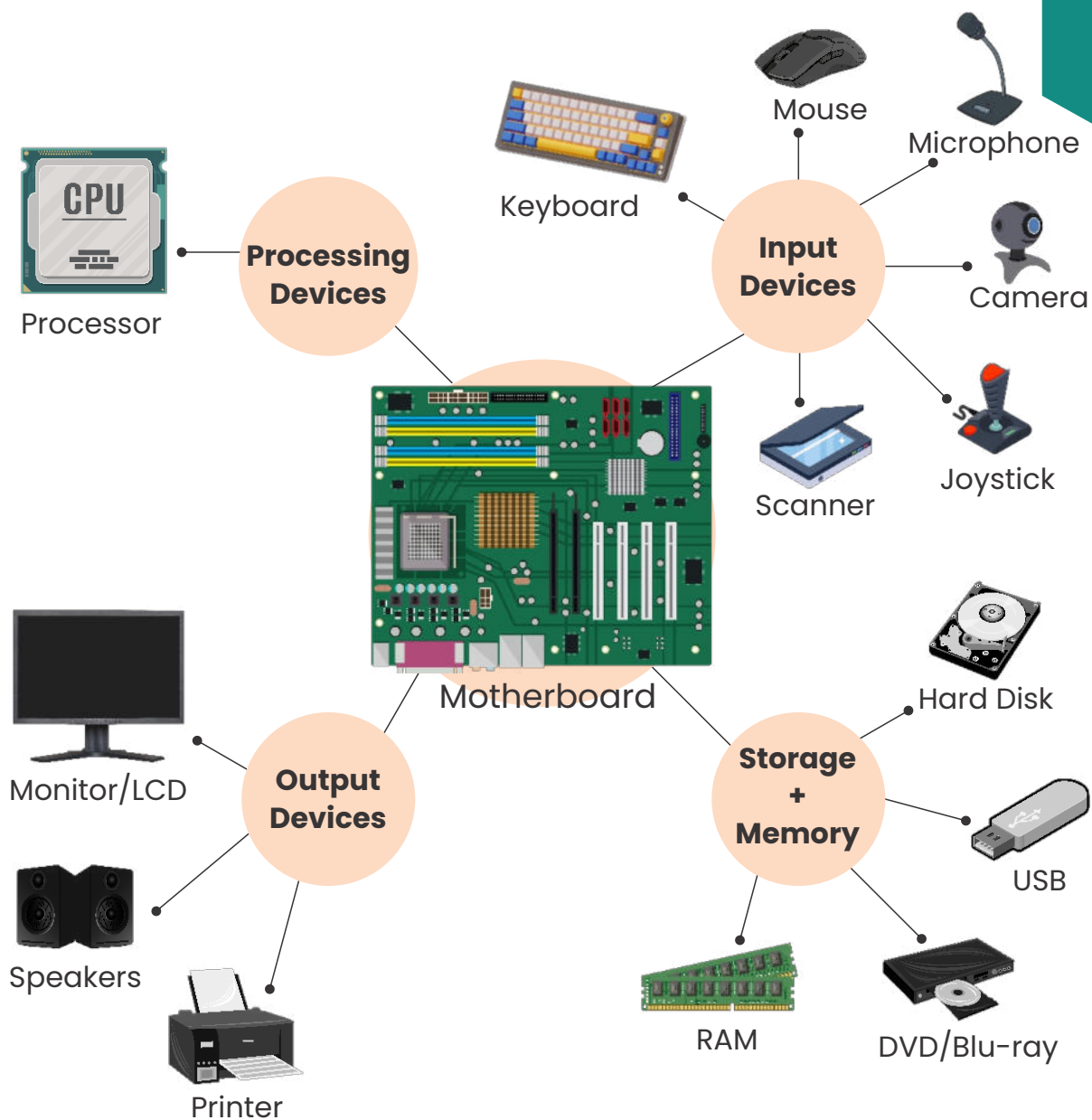
• COMPUTER CASING

The computer casing is the box that holds important parts like the motherboard, hard disk, RAM, and processor.



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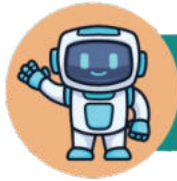
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EXERCISE 1

Circle the correct answer.

1. Which of the following is used mostly for playing games?

- | | |
|--------------------|-------------------|
| A RAM | B hardware |
| C hard disk | D joystick |

2. _____ is used to take pictures:

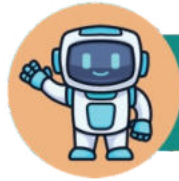
- | | |
|-------------------------|----------------------|
| A digital camera | B joystick |
| C hard disk | D motherboard |

3. _____ is an input device.

- | | |
|-------------------|------------------|
| A Keyboard | B Monitor |
| C Speaker | D Printer |

4. RAM stores data:

- | | |
|----------------------|-----------------------|
| A temporarily | B permanently |
| C manually | D collectively |



EXERCISE 2

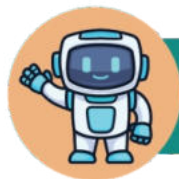


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Fill in the blanks.

1. All the parts of a computer which can be touched are collectively called _____.
2. RAM is also known as _____ memory.
3. Microphone is also called a _____.
4. We attach all the components of a computer to the _____.
5. _____ is the computer's permanent storage.



EXERCISE 3

Mark "True" or "False".

TRUE**FALSE**

Hardware refers to the physical parts of a computer.

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Motherboard is also called a Hard disk drive.

☐☐

Hard disk can store large amounts of data and information.

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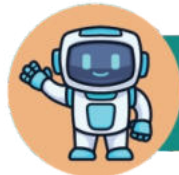
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Computer casing provides a power supply to the parts placed inside the casing.

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A joystick is used to edit documents.

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EXERCISE 4

Answer the following questions.

1. Define hardware.

Ans: _____

2. What is the role of the motherboard in a computer?

Ans: _____

3. What is the difference between RAM and a hard disk?

Ans: _____

4. What do connectors and ports do in a computer?

Ans: _____



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5. Define computer casing.

Ans: _____

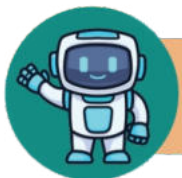
6. What would happen if the motherboard stops working?

Ans: _____

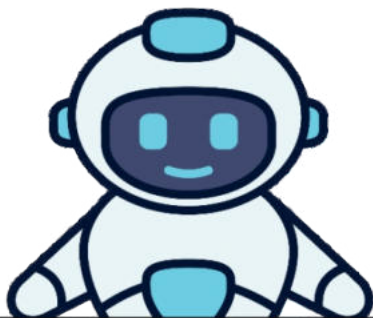


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LAB ACTIVITY



By getting the help of your teacher, open the computer casing and identify the key components such as motherboard, processor(CPU), RAM, hard disk, power supply and connectors.

TEACHER'S NOTE

Show the hardware parts of a computer to the students and explain the use of each part.